10th Class English • Unit 2 • Punjab Board (New Syllabus 2026)

My Beloved Pakistan (Poem)

Fully solved exercises: stanza-wise explanation, comprehension, MCQs, variety of texts, word families, dictionary work, inferred meanings, SDG presentation, dialogue writing

A. The Poem at a Glance

Poet: Anonymous (the poem is a patriotic song of unknown authorship). **Type:** a lyric poem of five stanzas of four lines each, with a simple **aabb** rhyme scheme and a soft, musical rhythm.

Central idea: Pakistan is a beautiful, rich and blessed land, and true patriotism means loving it, working for it, staying united and living in peace. The poet celebrates the land, the flag and the spirit of the people, and promises to serve the country for life.

Stanza	What it says (easy meaning)
1	The poet praises the green, fertile land, its wide skies and blue rivers. The mountains stand proudly and the spirit of the nation rises higher than the sky.
2	From the snowy peaks of the North to the burning deserts of the South, every grain of soil and every tree seems to whisper love and freedom.
3	The flag of green with the white star shines like a beacon (a guiding light) in the dark. The people hold it high, and the name of Pakistan lives in every heart.
4	Those who serve the country with grace are its pride. The poet asks all to work, to learn and to stand together until the brightest dream is achieved.
5	A personal promise: Pakistan is my home and my land, I will always stand for it, and I will do my part with peace and love.

Learn stanza 1 (beauty), 2 (landscape), 3 (flag and unity) and 5 (promise to serve) — the usual reference-to-context questions come from these.

B. Questions Given Beside the Poem

1. What does the word “patriotism” mean to you?

Patriotism means the deep love, loyalty and sense of duty that a person feels for his country. It is not only saying that we love Pakistan; it is proving it by our actions — by studying honestly, keeping our streets clean, obeying the law, paying taxes and helping the people of our land.

2. What symbols or things do you think represent Pakistan best?

The national flag (green with a white star and crescent), the national anthem, the mountains of the North, the Indus River, the Minar-e-Pakistan, the Badshahi Mosque, our national dress and our brave people represent Pakistan best.

3. How do you show love for your country in everyday life?

I show it by respecting the flag and standing silently during the anthem, by keeping my school and street clean, by following traffic and school rules, by helping the poor and the elderly, by being honest in the exam hall and by taking part in activities that bring a good name to my school and my country.

4. If you could describe Pakistan in three words, what would they be and why?

Beautiful, brave and blessed. It is beautiful because it has snowy peaks, green plains, rivers and deserts within one land. It is brave because its people faced floods, earthquakes and wars without breaking. It is blessed because the Muslim dream of a separate homeland was fulfilled here in 1947.

5. What qualities of the land are being celebrated?

The poem celebrates the greenness and fertility of the land, its wide skies, its blue rivers, the proud and high mountains of the North, the glowing deserts of the South, the blooming trees and the freedom-loving spirit of its people.

6. How does the poet use symbolism in describing the flag?

The green flag with the white star is a symbol of the land, of the faith of the people and of unity. The white star and the shining flag are compared to “a beacon in the night” — a guiding light that shows the way in darkness. Holding it high is a symbol of pride and strength, and “in every heart your name belongs” shows that love for the country is inside every citizen, not only on the flagpole.

7. What message does the speaker convey about their relationship to Pakistan?

The speaker says “O Pakistan, my home, my land” and promises that he will always make his stand for it and will do his part with peace and love. So the relationship is not that of a citizen and a country only; it is the relationship of a child with his motherland — one of lifelong love, loyalty and service. The country owns his heart, and he asks nothing in return.

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C. Reading Comprehension — Answer the following questions

1. What is the overall message of the poem?

The overall message of the poem is that Pakistan is a beautiful and blessed homeland which deserves our whole-hearted love. The poet tells the reader that patriotism is not only a feeling but a duty: we must work for the country, seek knowledge, remain united, live in peace and be ready to serve and sacrifice. The poem also gives a message of hope — if all of us stand as one, the brightest dream of Pakistan will surely be achieved.

2. How does the poet show love for Pakistan?

The poet shows his love in three ways. **First**, he praises the beauty of the land — its green fields, wide skies, blue rivers, snowy peaks and glowing deserts. **Second**, he honours its symbols: he holds the flag high and calls it a beacon of light. **Third**, he gives a personal promise of service — “Forever will I make my stand” and “With peace and love, I'll do my part”. Love for him is shown by action, not only by words.

3. Which natural features of Pakistan have been mentioned in the poem?

The poem mentions the green and fertile land, the wide skies, the blue rivers, the high and proud mountains, the snowy peaks of the North, the glowing deserts of the South, the soil and the blooming trees. Together they show that Pakistan is a land of great natural variety and beauty.

4. What symbols in the poem represent unity and patriotism?

The main symbols are: **(i) the flag** of green with the white star, which stands for the land, the faith and the unity of the nation; **(ii) the beacon**, the light that guides in the night; **(iii) the words “we hold it high”**, which show collective pride; **(iv) “in every heart your name belongs”**, which shows that patriotism lives in the heart of every citizen; and **(v) “we'll stand as one”**, the strongest symbol of national unity.

5. How can students like you express patriotism in daily life?

Students can express patriotism without waiting for any big occasion. They should study honestly, because an educated citizen is the greatest strength of a country. They should respect the flag and the national anthem, keep their school and street clean, plant and water trees, follow traffic and discipline rules, help the poor and the needy, take part in sports and social work that bring honour to the country, and speak the truth and stand against injustice. In short, a good student today is an honest and useful citizen tomorrow.

D. Choose the Correct Option (MCQs) — solved with key

1. What is the main theme of the poem?

- friendship
- nature and seasons
- patriotism and love for country
- hard work and honesty

Answer: patriotism and love for country — Every stanza praises the land and the flag and calls for service.

2. What does the poet compare the flag to?

- a painting
- a beacon in the night
- a bright flower
- a flying bird

Answer: a beacon in the night — The line is “Shines like a beacon in the night”.

3. Which part of Pakistan has been described as having snowy peaks?

- the South
- the North
- the East
- the West

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Answer: the North — The poem says “From snowy peaks of mighty North”.

4. What does the poet encourage the young people to do for Pakistan?

travel abroad
work, learn, and stand united
memorize poetry
plant trees only

Answer: work, learn, and stand united — The line is “We'll work, we'll learn, we'll stand as one”.

5. What natural features have been mentioned in the poem?

skyscrapers and highways
beaches and oceans
deserts, rivers, and mountains
forests and lakes

Answer: deserts, rivers, and mountains — Green land, blue rivers, snowy peaks and glowing deserts are all named.

6. Which emotion is the strongest in the poem?

anger
pride and devotion
joy
confusion

Answer: pride and devotion — The tone is proud and devoted from the first line to the last.

E. Short Paragraph — Perspectives and Understanding

Topic: How did hearing different perspectives influence my understanding of the poem?

When my class discussed “My Beloved Pakistan”, every group read the poem with its own eyes. One group explained the beauty of the mountains and deserts, another connected the flag with the sacrifices of 1947, and a third linked the lines to the SDGs of clean environment and quality education. Earlier I read the poem only as a description of nature, but after hearing these views I understood that the poet is not simply praising scenery — he is asking us to act like responsible citizens. The discussion also changed my personal answer to the question “how do you show patriotism”, because a class-fellow's example of keeping the school clean taught me that patriotism begins in small daily habits. So listening to different perspectives turned my single, narrow reading into a complete and practical understanding of the poem.

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F. Paragraphs Join Together to Make a Comprehensive Text

Every text is a group of paragraphs, and each paragraph does one job in the whole. A well-written text opens with the **main idea**, then gives **supporting details** and finally ends with a **conclusion** or a call to action. Read the text “The Power of Trees” with this chart:

Paragraph	Job it does	Evidence from the text
A	Main idea — introduces the importance of trees	“They help clean the air by absorbing carbon dioxide and releasing oxygen.”

Paragraph	Job it does	Evidence from the text
B	Supporting detail — one big danger	"Trees are being cut down faster than they can grow back… called deforestation."
C	More supporting details — examples of benefits	"Trees also provide food, shelter, and medicine…"
D	Conclusion and call to action	"Planting a tree, recycling paper… protect the future of our planet."

Main idea of the whole text in one line: trees are necessary for life, deforestation is destroying them, and every one of us can help to protect them.

Why the order matters: if paragraph B came first, the reader would meet a problem before knowing why trees matter. If paragraph D came first, he would be asked to act before he was convinced. This is why a text is arranged as **idea → details → conclusion**: the paragraphs must support each other to make one complete and convincing whole.

G. Variety of Texts — Fiction, Non-fiction and Poetry

Genre	Definition	Example given in the unit
Fiction	Prose that describes imaginary events and people	"The Secret Garden Bench" (short story)
Non-fiction	Prose based on facts, real events and real people, such as biography or history	"The Importance of Clean Water" (article)
Poetry	Writing that expresses feelings, ideas or stories in a creative and often rhythmic way, using rhyme, imagery and figurative language	"My Beloved Pakistan"

Questions on the variety of texts (model answers)

1. What is the main difference between fiction and non-fiction?

Fiction is the product of the writer's imagination: its characters and events are invented, and the aim is to entertain and to touch feelings. Non-fiction is based on facts, real events and real people, and its aim is to inform, explain or record. So the test is simple — if the events really happened, the text is non-fiction; if they are imagined, it is fiction.

2. How is a poem different from a short story?

A short story tells a complete story with characters, a setting, a plot and a moral, and it is written in ordinary prose sentences. A poem is short, musical and arranged in lines and stanzas with rhyme and rhythm, and it mainly expresses a feeling or an idea through imagery and figurative language instead of telling a story in detail. A story describes events; a poem makes us feel them.

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3. Which genre helped you learn something new today? What did you learn?

The non-fiction article “The Importance of Clean Water” taught me something new and useful: that clean water is not only needed for drinking but also for agriculture and for keeping the environment balanced, and that many communities still do not have it. I also learnt that water conservation at home is a lesson in citizenship.

4. Which genre made you feel something strongly? What emotion did you feel?

The poem “My Beloved Pakistan” made me feel proud. When I read the lines about the flag shining like a beacon and the promise “With peace and love, I'll do my part”, I felt a strong sense of pride, devotion and responsibility as a Pakistani student.

5. Which genre did you enjoy the most? Why?

I enjoyed the short story “The Secret Garden Bench” the most, because it is short, simple and full of feeling. The idea of an unknown person writing harmless notes of kindness and leaving them under a bench is beautiful, and it made me think that I too can make somebody happy with a very small act.

6. Would you recommend one of the texts to a friend? Which one and why?

Yes, I would recommend the poem “My Beloved Pakistan” to my friends, because it is easy to memorise and it gives true patriotism in four short phrases — work, learn, stand united and live in peace. Any student who understands these four things will do something good for the country.

7. If you could write your own text, would you choose to write a story, an article, or a poem? Explain your choice.

I would choose to write a story, because a story can teach a lesson without preaching. A poem limits me by rhyme and a short length, and an article gives only facts. In a story I can create characters who face a problem, make a mistake and change, and the reader learns the lesson with the character — which is why stories stay in our memory longer than lessons.

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H. Glossary — Words and Meanings

Word	Meaning
beacon	a light or other visible object serving as a signal or a guide
blooming	producing or yielding flowers; flowering
glowing	shining with, or as if with, warmth or heat
peace	harmony, freedom from war and violence
pride	a feeling of deep pleasure or satisfaction
soars	flies or rises high in the air
strive	makes great efforts to achieve or obtain something

I. Vocabulary and Grammar

1. Word Family Detective — complete the table

Root word	Verb	Noun	Adjective
analyze	analyze	analysis	analytical
advocate	advocate	advocacy	advocative (rare)
decide	decide	decision	decisive
educate	educate	education	educational
create	create	creation	creative

2. The five root words in sentences of your own

analyze: The teacher asked us to analyze the causes of air pollution in our city.
advocate: Our headmaster advocates the planting of trees in every school.
decide: We decided to clean the classroom every Saturday.
educate: The government must educate every child of the village.
create: A good writer creates a picture in the mind of the reader.

3. Dictionary, thesaurus table (solved)

Word	Meaning	Pronun-ciation	Part of speech	Etymology	Synonym
beacon	a light used as a signal	/ˈbiːkən/	noun	Old English bēacn (sign)	signal, lighthouse
blooming	producing flowers	/ˈbluːmɪŋ/	adjective	from bloom, Old Norse blóm	flowering, flourishing
glowing	shining with warmth	/ˈgləʊɪŋ/	adjective	Old English glōwan (to glow)	radiant, shining
peace	freedom from war	/piːs/	noun	Latin pax through Old French pais	calm, harmony
pride	a feeling of deep satisfaction	/praɪd/	noun	Old English prȳde	honour, self-respect
soars	rises high in the air	/sɔːz/	verb	Old French essorer (fly up)	rises, flies high

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Word	Meaning	Pronun-ciation	Part of speech	Etymology	Synonym
strive	to make great efforts	/straɪv/	verb	Old French estriver (to contend)	struggle, endeavour

4. Inferred Meanings of Unfamiliar Words — "The Forgotten Garden"

1. What does "neglected" suggest about the state of the garden before Hania found it?

"Neglected" suggests that the garden had been left without any care for a long time. Its hedges were overgrown, its stone wall was crumbling, its vines had covered everything and the villagers avoided it. In short, it was forgotten, untidy and wild — a place nobody looked after.

2. In "But Hania was not so easily deterred", what does "deterred" mean? What clues help you?

"Deterred" means discouraged or stopped from doing something by fear or difficulty. Here it means Hania was not frightened away by the strange tales and the ruined gate. **Clues:** the word "But" shows a contrast, and the next line explains her — she had "an adventurous spirit" and "had always been drawn to "mysteries", so she would not turn back.

3. The gate's hinges are described as "groaning in protest". What does this personification suggest?

A hinge cannot groan, so the writer gives it a human quality. It suggests that the gate was very old, rusted and stiff, and that its iron made a long, low, painful creaking sound when it was pushed. It also creates a mysterious, slightly frightening mood at the entrance of the garden.

4. The petals are described as "luminescent". What does the word mean here?

The word comes from the Latin lumen (light). In the passage it means that the petals gave out a soft light of their own, as if they were glowing in the dark. This is why the garden "seemed to glow" at sunset and looked magical rather than ordinary.

5. What does it mean that Hania was "mesmerized" by the gentle light?

"Mesmerized" means completely held, spellbound and unable to move or look away. It shows that Hania was so deeply attracted by the soft light that she stood still and forgot herself. Her reaction was not fear but wonder and delight.

J. Oral Communication Skills — The SDGs and Patriotism

The **Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs)** are 17 global goals set by the United Nations in 2015 under Agenda 2030. They aim to end poverty, hunger and inequality and to protect the planet by the year 2030, so that no one is left behind. Pakistan is also working for them.

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SDG	Connection with the poem
SDG 4: Quality Education	“We'll work, we'll learn…” — promoting learning and growth
SDG 16: Peace, Justice and Strong Institutions	The call for peace, unity and responsibility
SDG 13: Climate Action	Love of rivers, mountains and nature leads to their protection
SDG 10: Reduced Inequalities	Unity and shared pride among all people
SDG 17: Partnerships for the Goals	Standing together to build a better nation

Model group presentation — SDG 4 with the poem

Respected teacher and dear friends, our group has been given SDG 4, Quality Education, and we link it with the line of our national poem “We'll work, we'll learn, we'll stand as one”. The poet does not put learning after patriotism; he puts it inside patriotism. Our real-life issue is that in many villages of Pakistan children leave school before class five, and girls are the first to be taken out. Our suggestion is simple: in every village the school building must be safe and clean, every child must get a free textbook and a midday meal, and the educated students of that village must teach the younger ones for one hour every evening. If we do this, the words “we'll learn” will stop being poetry and start being a plan. Thank you.

K. Writing Skills — Writing a Dialogue

A good dialogue has **three parts**: a short **setting** in brackets that tells the place, time and mood; **characters** who speak in their own style; and **stage directions** in brackets that show the expression or action of the speaker, as a director's notes do. The purpose and the ending must be clear.

Model dialogue: “What Pakistan Means to Me”

[A school courtyard after the morning assembly. The national flag flutters in the breeze. Two students, AHMED and MARYAM, sit on a bench with their notebooks.]

AHMED: [looking up at the flag] Every time the assembly ends, I feel I have promised something to this flag.

MARYAM: [smiling] That is exactly what patriotism is, Ahmed. My father says patriotism is a promise, not a poster.

AHMED: [curiously] But what can we two promise? We are only students.

MARYAM: [firmly] We can promise three things. To study honestly, to keep our city clean, and never to cheat to get marks.

AHMED: [laughing softly] The first two are easy. The third one costs more.

MARYAM: [seriously] Everything good costs more. My elder sister wants to be a nurse, and she says serving a patient in Pakistan is greater than serving anywhere

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else in the world.

AHMED: [nodding, then looking at his notebook] Then I will be an engineer who builds strong school buildings, not weak ones that fall in the first rain. That is my part.

MARYAM: [standing up] Good. And mine is to teach the children of my street in the evening, free of cost.

[The bell rings. They pick up their notebooks and walk towards the class, both looking once more at the flag.]

Proofreading and Editing — "What It Means to Be a Responsible Citizen"

The passage given in the book is a fair first draft. Read it aloud and note these weaknesses, then compare it with the improved version in the book:

Weak point in the draft	Why it is weak	Improvement
Repeated first-person phrases: "I think", "I believe"	Repetition weakens a formal piece of writing	Use one clear statement and give the opinion once
Conversational words: "garbage", "a lot cleaner"	Too informal for a written passage	Replace with "littering" and "cleaner and safer"
Overused words: "thing", "it"	The reader cannot see exactly what is meant	Name the thing: traffic signals, public bins, trust
Very long sentences with "and", "but"	The main idea gets lost in the middle	Break into two short sentences
Weak last line "It's about everyday behaviour"	No clear call to action	End with a sentence that tells what it does for society

The corrected version replaces "garbage on the streets" with "littering", adds the idea of using public bins, and closes with "we help build a stronger, safer, and more united society".

Lesson for your own writing: edit for content, order and word choice, then proofread for spelling, punctuation, capitals and grammar. Do not change the meaning of a passage while improving its words.

L. Summary of the Unit

"My Beloved Pakistan" is an anonymous patriotic poem in five short stanzas. The poet begins with the green, fertile land, its wide skies, blue rivers and proud mountains, and says the spirit of the nation soars above the sky. He then moves from the snowy peaks of the North to the glowing deserts of the South and hears love and liberty whispered in every grain of soil and every tree. The green flag with its white star shines like a beacon in the night; the people hold it high and the name of Pakistan lives in every heart. The poet praises all who serve and strive, and calls the nation to work, to learn and to stand as one until the brightest dream is won. In the last stanza he makes his personal promise to stand for Pakistan forever and to

do his part with peace and love. The message is that love for the country must be proved by education, unity, peace and service.

Points to Remember

• Poet: anonymous. Form: 5 stanzas × 4 lines, rhyme scheme aabb, tone of pride and devotion.

• Main symbols: the flag of green and white star, the beacon in the night, "we'll stand as one", "in every heart your name belongs".

• Natural features named: green land, wide skies, blue rivers, snowy peaks of the North, glowing deserts of the South, blooming trees.

• Poet's advice to the youth: work, learn, stand united, keep peace, serve selflessly.

• Glossary words: beacon, blooming, glowing, peace, pride, soars, strive.

• Word families: analyze–analysis–analytical; advocate–advocacy; decide–decision–decisive; educate–education–educational; create–creation–creative.

• Fiction = imagined; non-fiction = facts; poetry = feeling, rhythm, imagery.

• A text is built as main idea → supporting details → conclusion.

• Dialogue needs a setting in brackets, characters with their own style, and stage directions in brackets.

• Editing = content, order, word choice; proofreading = spelling, punctuation, capitals, grammar.

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